

Control access to Cost explorer

You can control the access to Cost Explorer in a similar way as done for all other AWS resources. It can be enabled with root credentials only. As soon as you enable Cost Explorer all other users of your organization can view Cost Explorer. Now all members of your organization need not know the billing details. Ideally, you'd want to restrict access to a few users only. To achieve this, you just need to create an IAM User group. Then add those users to that group in order to grant them access.

AWS Budget

In real life, we create a budget to control our expenditure and to keep expenses within a certain limit. Similarly, with AWS budget you can plan your service usage so that the service cost remains within a certain limit. You can set your own custom budget in terms of cost and usage. It will also alert you if the cost exceeds your budgeted amount. You can also customise the period of your AWS budget. It can range from monthly, quarterly, yearly or you can specify the start and end date of your budget. Your costs, subscription, or refunds can also be tracked through AWS budget.

AWS budgets can be categorised into the following types:

- **Cost Budget** – You can specify an amount that you want to spend on a device using this budget. For example, the amount you want to spend for your S3 bucket subscription.
- **Usage Budget** – Usage budget helps you to specify the time of usage. For example, how many hours you want to use your EC2 instance.
- **RI Utilization** – These types of budget work on a utilisation threshold defined by you and you will receive alerts whenever RIs are below this threshold.

Creating A budget:

You need to follow the following steps for creating a budget.

- Choose the option Budgets under 'Billing and Cost' in the management console. You will get an option "Create budget".
- Specify budget type as well as the time period for your budget. You can create a monthly, quarterly or yearly budget. For RI utilisation budget, you can also go for daily budget. For cost or usage budget you should specify the start date, end date and amount. Start date and end date specification is optional.